MIL-T-36589B
27 April 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-36589A
26 July 1974 and
MIL-D-36589
25 August 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TUBES, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, THORACIC, PLASTIC, RADIOPAQUE, STERILE, DISPOSABLE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers sterile, 20-inch long, radiopaque, thoracic surgical drainage tubes for use following surgery. The drainage tubes shall be disposable, transparent plastic tubes.

1.2 Classification. The drainage tubes shall be of the following types and sizes as specified (see 6.1):

Type	
I.	Right angle, 6 eyes
II.	Straight, 6 eyes

Size	
1	28 French
2	32 French
3	36 French

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

MMM-A-250	- Adhesive, Water-Resistant, (For Sealing Fiberboard Boxes.)
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.

FSC 6515

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PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup, Paperboard.
PPP-T-76 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper (for carton sealing).

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL-S-36586 - Sterilization Strip Test, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The Pharmacopeia of the United States of America (USP)

(Applications for copies shall be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pennsylvania 18042).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 638 Method of Test for Tensile Properties of Plastics

(Applications for copies shall be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pa. 19103).

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UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE:
FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations promulgated thereunder

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Public Information, Food and Drug Administration, 5600 Fishers Lane, Rockville Md. 20852).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The tubing shall be of a medical grade, clear, transparent, pliant polyvinyl chloride plastic. The tube shall meet United States Pharmacopeia (USP) requirements for Class IV Plastics, and for Transfusion and Infusion Assemblies.

3.2 Style, design, and dimensions.

3.2.1 The 20-inch long, sterile, disposable, plastic tube shall be radiopaque, beveled at the proximal end and have oval eyes located symmetrically around the tube at the distal end. The distal end is that which goes into the chest following surgery and the proximal end permits atraumatic placement during thoracostomy. The surgical drainage tube shall provide a full lumen connection to a drainage tube. Tubes shall have smooth interior and exterior walls, permitting unrestricted passage of fluids and be free from foreign substances and particulate matter.

3.2.1.1 Radiopacity. The tube shall have a radiopaque stripe for its entire length and 75 percent of its wall thickness. The stripe shall be uniform in width and be .030 inch minimum. The radiopaque stripe need not be present at the enlarged proximal end.

3.2.1.2 Distal end. The distal end of the tube shall be smoothly finished at the tip. The eyes shall be located at the distal end.

3.2.1.3 Proximal end. The proximal end shall be enlarged, beveled and smoothly finished. The length of the bevel shall be 1.70 $\pm$ .30 inches.

3.2.1.4 Eyes. The tube shall have oval eyes located at the distal end and they shall be placed symmetrically around the tube. The longitudinal axis of the eye farthest from the distal tip shall coincide with the radiopaque stripe.

3.2.1.5 Shape. The 20-inch long tubes shall be straight with the exception of the Type I tubes. These shall have an approximate right angle bend with the short leg about 5 inches long at the distal end of the surgical drainage tube.

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3.2.1.6 Dimensions. The following dimensions apply to the following types and sizes:

Types	Sizes	A minimum	B minimum	C ± .015/ ± .010	D ± .013	E ± .020	F ± 1/4
II	1	.047	.195	.360 x .140	.367	.472	4
II	2	.052	.230	.380 x .165	.419	.511	4
I	2	.052	.230	.380 x .165	.419	.511	3-1/4
II	3	.056	.260	.400 x .165	.472	.538	4
I	3	.056	.260	.400 x .165	.472	.538	3 1/4

NOTE: All dimensions are in inches.

A Wall thickness
B Diameter - opening into lumen at distal end
C Eyes (typical) width x height (width is on longitudinal axis of the tube)
D Outer Diameter - distal end
E Outer Diameter - proximal end
F Distance eyes extend from distal end

3.3 Physical properties.

3.3.1 Tensile strength. The minimum tensile strength shall be 1500 pounds per square inch (psi) when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.3.2 Elongation. The minimum elongation shall be 225 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.4 Sterility. The thoracic surgical drains shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.5.1.

3.4.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification
b. National stock number (NSN)
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and date of tests.

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k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.4.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.5 Safety (nontoxicity) and freedom from pyrogens. The tubes shall be safe and pyrogen free when tested as specified in 4.5.2 and 4.5.3.

3.6 Animal Implantation Test. The tubing shall show no evidence of causing an adverse tissue reaction when tested as specified in 4.5.7.

3.7 Radiopacity. The tubes shall have a radiopaque stripe that shows as a definite shadow when tested as specified in 4.5.6.

3.8 Certificates of freedom from pyrogens, safety and animal implantation tests. A certificate listing all lot or control numbers shall state that representative samples from each lot or control have been tested and found safe to be free from pyrogens, and have passed the animal implantation test. This certificate shall include the specific tests performed and the test results. The record of the animal implantation test and its results shall be certified by the pathologist who performed or supervised performance of the animal implantation test. For destination inspection, certificates shall be submitted by the contractor directly to Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, Technical and Quality Assurance Division, 2800 S. 20th St., Philadelphia, Pa. 19101, Attention: Quality Assurance Branch, and one copy of each shall be forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. For source inspection, certificates shall be furnished to the procuring activity via the government inspector.

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3.9 Manufacturer's record. The manufacturer shall place a code or lot number on the paper label, which can be verified against the manufacturer's records of all tests made on animal implantation, sterile, pyrogen-free tubes. These records shall be made available for inspection by any duly authorized Government representative. No shipment shall be made until all tests have been completed, verified, and recorded in the permanent records of the manufacturer.

3.10 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The finished tubes shall be symmetrical in shape, and the surface shall have a smooth finish, free from irregularities or imperfections of any kind which detract from their appearance or which may impair their serviceability. The drainage tubes must be visually clean and free from foreign matter and soils.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I. The unit of product for examination shall be one drainage tube.

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TABLE I. Sampling for examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)*
Major	S-2	1.0
Minor	S-2	1.5

* If acceptance number is not exceeded, lot shall be accepted. If rejection number is equaled or exceeded, inspection at level II shall be performed to determine final rejection or acceptance.

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as shown in Table II.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests

Characteristic	Unit of product	Reqmt	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Radiopacity	Tube	3.7	4.5.6	S-2	1.5
Tensile strength	Tube	3.3.1	4.5.4	S-2	1.5
Elongation	Tube	3.3.2	4.5.5	S-2	1.5
Sterility	Tube	3.4	4.5.1	S-2	*
Safety and	Tube		4.5.2		
freedom from pyrogens		3.5	4.5.3	S-2	*
Animal implantation	Tube	3.6	4.5.7	S-2	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.2.3 Test samples. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination. The drainage tubes shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in the specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any drainage tube in the sample, containing one or more defects shall be rejected (defective) and if the number of defective drainage tubes in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected (see 4.2.1).

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TABLE III. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Rough edges to eyes and distal end.
102	Dimensions out of tolerance.
103	Embedded particles.
104	Tackiness.
105	Presence of foreign matter.
Minor	
201	Small bubble within plastic.

4.4 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Examination for preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging & packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size location, sequence, or method of application.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

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4.5.1 Sterility test. The thoracic surgical drainage tube shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for parenteral devices using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.5.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in Table II, Sampling Criteria for Tests.

4.5.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.5.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.5.1 Sterility test and 4.5.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.5.1.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.5.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

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4.5.1.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

4.5.2 Safety. Tubes shall be tested for safety in accordance with the USP for transfusion and infusion assemblies.

4.5.3 Non-Pyrogenicity. Tubes shall be tested for freedom from pyrogens in accordance with the USP for transfusion and infusion assemblies.

4.5.4 Tensile strength. Tubes shall be tested for tensile strength in accordance with ASTM D 638 Method of Test for Tensile Properties of Plastics.

4.5.5 Elongation. Tubes shall be tested for elongation in accordance with ASTM D 638 Method of Test for Tensile Properties of Plastics.

4.5.6 Radiopacity. The plastic drainage tube shall be placed on an unexposed X-ray plate and covered with an aluminum step wedge ranging in thickness from 1/8 inch to 3/4 inch in steps of 1/8 inch. Using an appropriate exposure so that the steps of at least 1/4, 3/8, 1/2 and 5/8 inch are clearly delineated from each other, the insert appearance shall be noted.

4.5.7 Animal implantation test. Samples of the drainage tubes shall be tested in accordance with method given in the USP for Implantation Test, except for the changes which follow: Last paragraph, second line after "72 hours", add "and not to exceed 144 hours." Last paragraph, third and fourth sentence, delete entirely and substitute "The tissues surrounding the implants shall be examined, both grossly and microscopically, by a pathologist certified by the American Board of Pathology or the American College of Veterinary Pathologists."

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing 10 drainage tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Immediate container. Each drain shall be packaged sterile (not coiled) in a rigid waterproof tube capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless container is damaged or opened. For right angle drains, the tube shall assume the same angle as the drain. Each tube shall be sealed with a tamper proof closure.

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5.1.2.2 Unit package. Ten immediate containers containing drainage tubes of one size only shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.3 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages containing drainage tubes of one size only shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676, type CF, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed by taping the top and bottom flaps with 2 inches wide tape conforming to PPP-T-76. Closing of bottom flaps with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

5.1.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two intermediate packages (24 units of one size) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Two intermediate packages (24 units of one size) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial Containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Immediate container. Each immediate container shall be marked with the item identification, manufacturer's name and address, size (French and nominal length) of unit, and sterility lot or control number. In addition, marking shall include the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetics Act and shall include the legend or similar statement:

"STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED".

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* 5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility, lot (control) number, name and address of manufacturer, name of contractor, contract or purchase order number and method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, C-Cold, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-8/75-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number, name of contractor and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

5.3.4 Exterior containers. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall also be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Notes. This specification covers the following thoracic surgical drainage tubes appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification	Specification Designation Type	Size
6515-00-140-7999	TUBE, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, Thoracic, Plastic, Radiopaque, Right Angle, Sterile, Disposable, 32 Fr, 10s	I	2
6515-00-140-8000	TUBE, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, Thoracic, Plastic, Radiopaque, Right Angle, Sterile, Disposable, 36 Fr, 10s	I	3
6515-00-763-7366	TUBE, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, Thoracic, Plastic, Radiopaque, Straight, Sterile, Disposable, 32 Fr, 10s	II	2
6515-00-763-7367	TUBE, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, Thoracic, Plastic, Radiopaque, Straight, Sterile, Disposable, 28 Fr, 10s	II	1
6515-00-866-9073	TUBE, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, Thoracic, Plastic, Radiopaque, Straight, Sterile, Disposable, 36 Fr, 10s	II	3

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.

(b) Selections of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(c) Applicable NSN.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet Military requirements. It does not include all types, sizes or grades as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1994

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

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INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-T-36589B - TUBES, DRAINAGE, SURGICAL, THORACIC, Plastic, Radiopaque Sterile, Disposable

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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